

PHY1101

Introductory Classical Mechanics

Course announcements

Semester A, 2026/27

Department of Physics · City University of Hong Kong

Course leader: ZHONG Yiming | Instructor: WANG Xin (“Sunny”)



Course leader

ZHONG Yiming · yiming.zhong@cityu.edu.hk

B.Sc.	2009
M.Sc.	2010
Ph.D.	2016
Postdoctoral researcher	2016 – 2023
Assistant Professor, CityUHK	2023 – present

Research interest

Theoretical particle physics, astrophysics, and cosmology



Instructor

WANG Xin (“Sunny”) · x.wang@cityu.edu.hk

B.Sc.	2005
Ph.D.	2010
Postdoctoral researcher	2010 – 2015
Assistant Professor, CityUHK	2015 – 2020
Associate Professor, CityUHK	2020 – present

Research interest

Quantum physics and condensed matter physics (theoretical)



How to reach us

INSTRUCTORS

Name	Email	Phone
ZHONG Yiming (course leader)	yiming.zhong@cityu.edu.hk	3442 7094
WANG Xin (“Sunny”)	x.wang@cityu.edu.hk	3442 7815

Office hour: Tue 9:30-11:30 AM

TEACHING ASSISTANTS

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What we will cover

- * **Basic mathematics: vector analysis and calculus**
- * Units and dimensional analysis
- * Kinematics and reference frames
- * Newton's laws of motion
- * Energy
- * Gravity
- * Momentum
- * Rigid bodies and angular momentum
- * Special relativity

13

teaching weeks

Teaching schedule

Week	Date	Lecturer
1	1 Sep	Prof. ZHONG
2	8 Sep	Prof. WANG
3	15 Sep	Prof. WANG
4	22 Sep	Prof. WANG
5	29 Sep	Prof. WANG
6	6 Oct	Prof. WANG
7	13 Oct	Prof. WANG

Week	Date	Lecturer
8	20 Oct	Prof. ZHONG
9	27 Oct	Prof. ZHONG
10	3 Nov	Prof. ZHONG
11	10 Nov	Prof. ZHONG
12	17 Nov	Prof. ZHONG
13	24 Nov	Prof. ZHONG

Tutorials

WHEN THEY START

Week 3 (15 Sep)

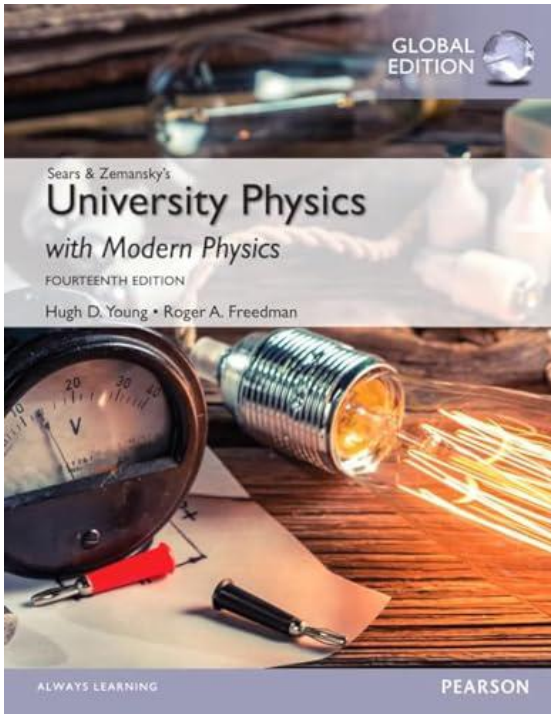
No tutorial in Week 1 or Week 2.

WHEN THEY RUN

Immediately **after** the class

Same place and day as the lecture — do not leave.

Textbook



H. D. Young and R. A. Freedman

University Physics with Modern Physics

Global Edition · Pearson

You do not need to buy it.

The e-book is available free through the CityU Run Run Shaw Library. The next slide shows how to get it.

Lecture notes will also be posted on Canvas.

Getting the e-book, free

1 Search the Library catalogue

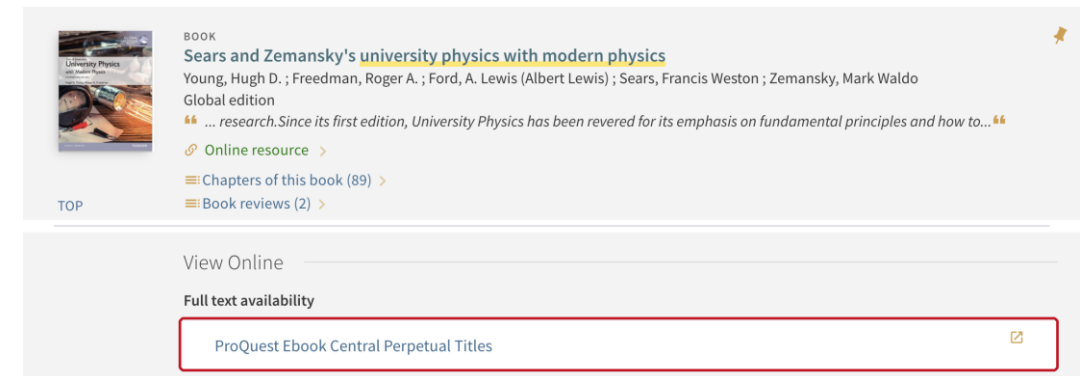
library.cityu.edu.hk → CityU LibraryFind → search “University Physics with Modern Physics”.



Red boxes mark where to click.

2 Open the record and click the e-book link

Under “View Online”, follow the ProQuest Ebook Central link. Sign in with your CityU account.



Assessment

30%

Homework

70%

Final exam

$\geq 30\%$

Exam hurdle

You must score at least 30% in the final exam to pass the course

- Homework is set in Weeks 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 and 11 — six assignments in total.
- There is no mid-term exam. The final exam carries 70% of the course mark.

Homework: how to submit

1 We only accept **online submission**

Upload **one single PDF** to Canvas. Merge multiple pages or photos first — **we only accept one PDF**.

2 Watch the due date

The due date is stated clearly on every assignment.

3 If you have difficulty uploading to Canvas

Email the PDF to the instructor before the deadline and say what went wrong.

Before you upload, check:

- One PDF, not several images
- Pages in the right order, right way up
- Question numbers clearly marked
- Legible handwriting, working shown

Well-organised, clean work is part of the mark — the TAs cannot give credit for working they cannot read.

Homework: deadlines and extensions

Up to 24 hours late

You keep 50% of the score you earn.

Beyond 24 hours

Homework more than 24 hours late will not be accepted. The assignment scores **zero** — submit whatever you have before the 24-hour mark.

With a doctor's note

If you have a **doctor's note**, the due date moves to the 2nd working day after the period you are excused for.

Other circumstances

Religious holidays, university duties and similar: email the instructor **in advance** to arrange something.

Policy on AI

You may use AI tools

AI is allowed for homework. It is not a shortcut past understanding — the exam is 70%.

Disclosure

You must disclose any AI use at the beginning of your submission. State the tool, what you used it for, and the scope.

If you do not disclose

Where the TAs have reasonable suspicion of undisclosed use, your **homework score will be reduced by 50%.**

EXAMPLE DISCLOSURE STATEMENTS

“AI disclosure: I used DeepSeek v4 for copy editing.”

“AI disclosure: I used ChatGPT-5.6 Sol to derive equations (3) to (5) of problem 1.”

“AI disclosure: I used Claude Fable 5 to extract data from the homework video.”

Be specific. “I used AI” is not a disclosure.

Classical mechanics in Sci-Fi movies

1 Watch

Short clips from science-fiction films.

2 Think

Which parts obey Newton's laws — and which do not?

3 Discuss

Work through the physics with the people around you.

4 Present

Share your reasoning with the class.



What this course is for

The goal

To build a real conceptual grip on **core physics concepts (inertial frame, momentum, angular momentum...)**, to make you familiar with the **fundamental methodology of physics (e.g. conservation...)**, and to give you a solid base for every physics course that follows.

One warning

This course leans heavily on **vector analysis and calculus**. A brief introduction is given in Week 1, but it is an introduction, not a full course. If you are shaky on either, start practising now — online resources are fine, and the sooner the better.

How to do well

This course will be *more difficult* than a typical 1xxx-level course.

1

Read more

Lecture notes, the textbook, and good online resources. Read before the lecture, not only after it.

2

Practise more

Homework, the supplemental problems (not mandatory, but they are where the learning happens), and anything else you can find.

3

Discuss more

Talk to the people next to you, to the TAs, and to us. Asking early is much cheaper than asking in Week 12.